

■ Networking Career Cards

NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Use these cards when Hats & Ladders is unavailable or when you need a second source. The education descriptions are typical pathways, not promises or requirements for every employer. Use Xello for current local salary information when it is available.

Network Administrator

Keeps a network running day to day. Common tasks include managing accounts and permissions, monitoring traffic, troubleshooting connections, installing updates, and documenting changes.

Typical preparation: Postsecondary certificate, associate degree, bachelor's degree, industry certification, or a mix of education and experience.

Technical focus: Networks, accounts, devices, monitoring, troubleshooting.

Network Architect

Plans and designs data communication networks. Common tasks include choosing equipment, planning capacity and security, documenting the design, and explaining costs and tradeoffs.

Typical preparation: Bachelor's degree plus related work experience is common.

Technical focus: Network design, capacity, security, hardware, cloud connections.

Database Administrator

Organizes, protects, backs up, and maintains data systems. Common tasks include controlling access, testing backups, monitoring performance, and helping users retrieve reliable data.

Typical preparation: Bachelor's degree is common; some roles accept related education, certifications, and experience.

Technical focus: Databases, access control, backups, performance, data reliability.

Systems Analyst

Studies how an organization works and recommends technology changes. Common tasks include interviewing users, mapping needs, comparing solutions, testing systems, and translating between technical and nontechnical teams.

Typical preparation: Bachelor's degree is common, though employers may accept other combinations of technical and business experience.

Technical focus: Requirements, systems, testing, process improvement, communication.

Compare the roles

CAREER	ONE TECHNICAL TASK	ONE TRANSFERABLE SKILL	WHY THAT SKILL MATTERS
Network Administrator			
Network Architect			
Database Administrator			
Systems Analyst			